

The Noble Heart of the Buddha: A Named Dhāraṇī

Ārya-buddha-hṛdaya-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 515 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སངས་རྒྱལ་གྱི་ཕ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་གི་ཟུངས།

Toh 515 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-buddha-hṛdaya-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Pakpa Sangyé Kyi Nyingpo Shéja Wé Zung, meaning "The Noble Heart of the Buddha." As its name suggests, it belongs to the dhāraṇī class of canonical literature, presenting a sacred formula and its associated teaching within a narrative frame in which the Buddha addresses an assembly of gods of the Pure Abodes. The text opens with the Buddha prophesying a future Tathāgata's teaching of the Dharma, situating the dhāraṇī within a broader vision of ongoing Buddhist transmission across time. It is preserved in the Kangyur in a version that was revised and definitively established through the correction of newly emerged terminology, indicating a careful editorial history in the Tibetan transmission.

Revised and definitively established through the correction of newly emerged terms.

In the Indian language: Ārya-buddha-hṛdaya-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The dhāraṇī called "The Noble Heart of the Buddha."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling in a pleasure grove by the shore of the ocean, seated upon a lion throne amid the trees of the buddhas' domain of activity, surrounded on all sides by a retinue of gods, facing forward, and teaching the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One declared to the sons of the gods of the Pure Abodes, headed by the Great Lord of Power Auspicious Ascetic, as follows: "Sons of the gods, therefore listen well, take it to mind, and I shall speak. In a later time, a Tathāgata will teach the Dharma-category of the dhāraṇī called 'The Heart of the Buddha' in order to gather in the four assemblies, to receive them under care, to fully receive them all under care, to bring them to distinction, to accomplish all aims and all Dharma in completeness, and to enable those who have genuinely entered the Great Vehicle to attain excellence in every aspect. He will uphold it.

Now, you are to take it to mind, and after I have passed into nirvāṇa, in the time to come you shall teach it to the four assemblies who have genuinely

entered the Great Vehicle, speak it, and without allowing it to be lost, proclaim it with certainty. For all those who have fallen into poverty and all those who are burdened with obscurations, preserve the speech of the Tathāgata, declare it with certainty, and proclaim it."

They replied: "Blessed One, so shall it be. Just as the Tathāgata has declared, so do we request it. In accordance with the Tathāgata's command, we shall fulfill this with diligence and completeness."

The Blessed One then declared: "Sons of the gods, what is the Dharma-category of the dhāraṇī called 'The Heart of the Buddha'? It is this:

tadyathā — amale, nirmale, sarva-ākāra-artha-paribhrāpte,
asamanta-sarva-kuna-ākāre-tryadhva, asaṅga-anābhṛte, samanta-daśa-diśa,
paripūrṇa-jñāne, sarva-asaṅga-darśana-prāpte,
sarva-dharma-maviśata-paripūrṇe, sarva-ākāra, asaṅga-samanvite,
samanta-apratihatā-tryadhva-daśasu-dikṣu-paribhrāpta-arthe, śānta,
praśānta, upaśānta, samaśānta, vimokṣa-anuprāpte,
supratibud-dha-dharmadhātu, atyanta-suniṣṛte, sarva-ākāra-nisasārāṇa,
anavaśeṣa-pāraṃgate, vipramukte, asaṃyoga, viprayoga-sthite-dharmate,
gagana-sama, prakṛti-pariśuddha, nirmale, asamanta, tryadhva-anugata,
suprāpte-pūrvānta, aparānta, madhya-tryadhva-samanta-anuprāpte,
anavaśeṣa, pariññā-prahāṇa, bhavana, sāksātkriyā-parama-pāraṃgate,
yathāvādita-tathākārī, sarva-ākāra-sampanne,
sarva-ākāra-mahā-maitrī-mahākaruṇā, sarva-ākārā-samasagraha-anuprāpte.

Sons of the gods, this is the Dharma-category of the dhāraṇī called 'The Heart of the Buddha.' Whatever son of good family or daughter of good family among the four assemblies who have genuinely entered the Great Vehicle carries it upon the body or recites it well and retains it should not think poorly of it. The Tathāgata, exactly as he is, will dwell at that person's crown of the head, at the border above it. Some will certainly come to see a buddha. Some will come to hear the Dharma. Some will come to teach the Dharma. Some will come to hold the dhāraṇī without forgetting it.

Those who abide on the path of training will find their stream of the path uninterrupted and their stream of teaching the Dharma uninterrupted. They will retain all their holdings without forgetting them. They will accomplish in a single birth what remains to be done. Being endowed with these qualities, they will attain the dhāraṇī that holds the entirety of the ocean of all that has been heard. They will attain the patient acceptance of the non-arising of

phenomena (anutpattikadharmakṣānti), and from that point onwards they will come to successively attain all things, up to and including the unobstructed liberation of a buddha in its complete fullness.

You must take to heart in this very life the intent of my teaching. And to those sons of good family or daughters of good family, you must teach it unmistakably and proclaim it. Do not discard it carelessly. Do not defer it. Do not forget it.

The assembly responded: Blessed One, we will accomplish it exactly so. This Dharma-category of the dhāraṇī called 'The Heart of the Buddha' — in the final age we will teach it to the four assemblies without deferral and without interruption, and we will expound it. To those sons of good family or daughters of good family as well we will teach it unmistakably and proclaim it. By doing so, we will be in accord with the scriptural word of the Tathāgata. We will thus have thoroughly preserved the noble Dharma of the Tathāgata. And for those sons of good family or daughters of good family it will be a great meaning and a great benefit.

The Blessed One then declared: Sons of the gods, therefore do exactly as has been said. This is the instruction I entrust to you.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the sons of the gods of the pure abodes — Maheśvara (Śiva) of excellent austerity and all the rest — together with the entire retinue, were filled with joy, and they offered praise to what the Blessed One had taught.

The noble dhāraṇī called 'The Heart of the Buddha' is complete.

This was translated by the Indian master Jinamitra and

Translator's Notes

- The opening phrase about "revision through newly emerged terms" refers to a Tibetan editorial note indicating that the translation was revised using newly coined standard terminology — a common feature of later canonical redactions in the bKa' 'gyur.

The mantra passage is transliterated Sanskrit embedded in the Tibetan text. The transliteration is uneven and contains several corrupted or non-standard forms. The rendering above follows the Tibetan phonetic spelling as closely as possible without emending to a reconstructed Sanskrit. Some syllables remain uncertain in their Sanskrit reconstruction; "kuna" and "nīsaṣārāṇa" in particular appear to be corruptions of more standard Sanskrit forms and their precise original readings are unclear.

The phrase rendered "the Great Lord of Power Auspicious Ascetic" translates dbang phyug chen po dka' thub bzang po, which appears to be a divine name or epithet for a deity of the

Pure Abodes rather than a commonly known figure; no Sanskrit equivalent is given in the text.

- The closing colophon is cut off mid-sentence, naming the Indian paṇḍita Jinamitra as one of the translators; the Tibetan collaborator's name does not appear in this passage. Jinamitra is well attested as one of the principal translators working at the imperial Tibetan court in the late eighth and early ninth centuries.

The phrase rendered "patent acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena" refers to the classical bodhisattva attainment of anutpattikadharmakṣānti, the direct realization that phenomena do not truly arise, a milestone on the bodhisattva path.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.